

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, October 12, 2016, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Assistant Mayor Bergeron at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present were:

Ward I Councilor Carolyn Towle
Ward II Councilor Scott Pope
At-Large Councilor Keith Raymond
Assistant Mayor Victor Bergeron
At-Large Councilor Allen Damren
At-Large Councilor Bruce Temple
Ward III Councilor Nicholas Koloski
At-Large Councilor John Simonds

Absent:

Mayor Charlene Lovett

Also present:

Guy Santagate, City Manager

Kenneth Tyree, Cub Scouts Webelos 2, Troop #38, led the Pledge of Allegiance.

AGENDA CHANGES

None

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Towle to accept the minutes of the July 27, 2016, City Council Meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

A motion was made by Ms. Towle and seconded by Mr. Pope to accept the minutes of the August 3, 2016, City Council Meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Ms. Towle to accept the minutes of the August 9, 2016, City Council Meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Towle to accept the minutes of the August 24, 2016, City Council Meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

A motion was made by Mr. Pope and seconded by Mr. Raymond to accept the minutes of the September 9, 2016, City Council Meeting.

Mr. Simonds abstained as he not at that meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0 with 1 abstain (Mr. Simonds).

A motion was made by Ms. Towle and seconded by Mr. Damren to accept the minutes of the September 14, 2016, City Council Meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Towle to accept the minutes of the September 26, 2016, City Council Meeting.

Mr. Simonds said the minutes showed him as arriving twice. He asked to leave that he arrived at 5:04 p.m. and remove the 5:11 p.m. arrival. Also, change the start of the meeting from 6 p.m. to 5 p.m.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0 as amended.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Simonds to accept the minutes of the September 28, 2016, City Council Meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

MAYOR'S NOTES

Leaf Pick Up and Free Tire Day

Mr. Bergeron said Monday, October 31 to Friday, November 4 will be leaf pick up in the City. November 5 at the Transfer Station will be Free Tire Disposal Day.

Ms. Towle said the Fall Festival was very well attended and very well run by the Parks and Recreation Department and the Greater Claremont Chamber of Commerce. She talked about attending a meeting regarding our children and how they can stay, play and live in Claremont.

She said it was well attended. She talked about youth sports and the positivity she sees in Claremont.

Mr. Bergeron said he went to the New Hampshire Industries open house. He said it is a great asset to the community. He said he went to Ink Factory's new building. He said it is almost finished and they've done a marvelous job.

Mr. Pope said Steven High School athletics teams are doing well.

Ms. Towle said the Tire Tracks event is on Saturday; there will be three bike tours; it starts at 10 a.m. at the Junction.

Proclamation for Dr. Alicia Harvey-Smith, former President, River Valley Community College

Assistant Mayor Bergeron read the proclamation into the record.

Mr. Santagate spoke about some of Dr. Harvey-Smith's accomplishments including getting the nursing program reaccredited and opening the Lebanon branch of the River Valley Community College. He congratulated her and wished her well.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Mr. Santagate talked about the open house at New Hampshire Industries. The building is three football fields long. The company will generate good paying jobs.

Department of Public Works – Fall Clean-up

Mr. Santagate said the Fall Clean-up is done annually. Residents need to put their leaves and grass clippings at curbside by 7 a.m. on October 31st and they need to be in compostable bags.

Free Tire Disposal Day

Saturday, November 5th, Public Works will host a Free Tire Disposal Day at the Transfer Station. They will accept tires that are less than 20".

Union Negotiations

The City is starting union negotiations. Preliminary meetings are being scheduled. Mr. Santagate will keep the Council informed.

Reminder – Conference of New Hampshire Conservation District, Thursday and Friday,
October 13th and 14th

The New Hampshire Association of Conservation Districts will be conducting a two-day seminar/meeting at the Common Man Restaurant in Claremont on October 13th and 14th. One of the reasons they have chosen Claremont is the great work our staff did in remediating the badly contaminated site along the Sugar River. This \$4 million cleanup was no small achievement and is recognized by environmentalists from across the state as a major success and a model for others to follow. He and the Mayor will participate in the event and Jane Taylor and Kurt Beek will make presentations at the workshop.

Forestry Management Plan Update

The Directors and representatives from the Conservation Commission are having a meeting about the Winter Street bid next Thursday. We need to make sure we are following the Management Plan and ask the low bidder to re-calculate his bid to just thinning a 1/3 of this property. He said before anything is done on Ridge Avenue, it will come back to Council.

Mr. Santagate said that Election Day is November 8th and Mr. Bergeron had mentioned that parent/teacher conferences were to be held at the Middle School that day. Dr. Middleton McGoodwin, School Superintendent, said the schedule has been changed, so that parent/teacher conferences will be held November 7th and there will be no school on November 8th. Mr. Santagate thanked the School Board for its cooperation on this.

Ms. Towle said at the last Council meeting there was a discussion about making crosswalks safer. She said by Leo's she saw someone almost get hit.

Mr. Santagate said this will be placed on the Traffic Advisory Committee's agenda to discuss.

Ms. Towle asked where the bike racks went that were in front of City Hall. Mr. Santagate said we can find out.

Ms. Towle talked about the Fire Department monthly report and asked how Council can help with property owners that don't show for inspections.

Fire Chief Rick Bergeron said that it is several property owners with recurring issues. The increased No Show Fee allows the Treasurer to take these to court if not paid. He's not sure how the Council can help at this time. At this point, it will require legal action against property owners that don't show up. The first step is Small Claims Court. In the past, they have procured administrative search warrants to complete the inspections without the property owner being present, but they don't have staff available to do that now. There is one other option and that is to enlist the assistance of the NH Fire Marshall's office, however they are so busy and it could take 1 to 1 ½ years to do an inspection and follow-up.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Historic District Commission

A motion was made by Mr. Pope and seconded by Mr. Damren to appoint Abigail Carman to seat 3 of the Historic District Commission.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Doreen (Dodi) Kidder spoke regarding Cody Lafont. She requested the Council submit a letter to the state requesting to expedite the investigation and release of information to the family. Mr. Bergeron said Council would have to talk to the City Attorney.

John Simonds stepped down from Council table to say that he is a candidate for re-election to Sheriff. He gave his background information and that his philosophy is that it is all about public service. He said he has gotten endorsements from every member of the Sullivan County Sheriff's office as well as others. He said he has served 26 years in law enforcement.

OLD BUSINESS

Ordinance 550 Cemetery Policy – Second Reading – Public Hearing

The purpose of this proposal is to revise the municipal cemetery rules and regulations, as recommended by the City Council Ad Hoc Policy Committee.

Enactment of this Ordinance will update and clarify the municipal cemetery rules and regulations.

Mr. Bergeron corrected some erroneous statements that were in the Eagle Times editorial. He said he has no decision-making powers at St. Mary's Cemetery; there are two citizens on the committee; and there is nothing in the proposed changes to the ordinance that have to do with picnics in the cemeteries.

A motion was made by Mr. Raymond and seconded by Mr. Damren to adopt Ordinance 550 Cemetery Policy.

Mr. Raymond read the explanation of proposed action into the record.

Tina Rock, Ward 2, said regarding Section 16-78, Conduct in Cemeteries, that she had gone to Policy Committee meetings to request some changes. She disagreed with the cemetery closing time of 4 p.m., because it gets dark so early. She thinks people should be able to sit and have a sandwich with their loved ones without having to ask permission of Public Works staff. She and her family take care of the plot (seed, fertilizer, hay, etc.).

Councilors pointed out the information about picnics was in the existing ordinance and was not changing.

Ms. Rock asked what is to happen with stones and shrubs that are currently around some plots. She suggested school kids do community hours by cleaning up sticks, etc. in the cemetery. She asked why citizens can't go in to help beautify it.

Ms. Rock said she thinks there are more important things to think about than her "shrine" (wood and plastic structure place over her son's grave) such as allowing people to go in at whatever time they want to mourn their loved ones. She thanked the 90 people who signed her petition to keep her shrine.

Debra Chase, Ward 2, said her has family in the same cemetery. She feels the cemetery is a personal place and if her grandson wants to put toy truck on her mother's gravestone, it should be okay as long the area is kept clean and neat. She doesn't see a problem with structures or putting something on the stone as long as it doesn't bother others. She suggested structures can be put on the first day of winter and taken down the first day of spring.

Sharon Boudreau, Ward 2, doesn't understand why Council wants to make more rules when they can't enforce what's on the books. She said there is hardly any grass at Mountainview Cemetery; it's mostly weeds. She said her personal rubbish barrel was removed. She likes to place wreaths on the graves. She likes to sit in the cemetery in the dark in peace and quiet. She said the family cleans up the area including mowing around her grandson's stone. She talked about the 52-inch mower being too big to fit between the stones.

Tom Wadslaben, Ward 1, thanked the Policy Committee and Council for the work that was done on this ordinance. He said we need to have laws and regulations in the City. He is not opposed to people grieving in their own way. There a lot more families there than the 90 that signed Ms. Rock's petition. He thinks it is offensive for other families to have to see structures and things that are similar to a yard sale. Regarding structures, he asked if they are allowed, where would they end. He agreed with the Council and thinks the ordinance is fair.

Sabrina Spiller, Ward 3, Old Newport Road, asked for reconsideration of the one monument rule on cemetery plots. She has a family plot of eight with one headstone for them. She recently lost her husband but because of that rule, she doesn't have a headstone for him at which to mourn.

Bill Matthews, Ward 2, said that civilized society has to have rules and regulations. He said you can't use a 52-mower if you have "trash" all over the place (some of the plots look like they are having a yard sale) and also, structures that don't have bearing on the cemetery.

Jill Davidson, Ward 1, said she appreciates all the work that went into this.

Christine Hooper, Ward 3, said it is not right for the City to micromanage what's right for peoples' own plots. She likes to put memorabilia on plots. That's the way she shares holidays with her loved ones. She sees no problem with Ms. Rock having her structure in the cemetery.

Scott Sweet, Public Works Director, said regarding Mrs. Spiller's request for a headstone, you can put as many stones, in a line, as will fit on the lot.

Ms. Rock asked about Union Cemetery headstone rules. Mr. Sweet said West Claremont Burial Ground is in charge of that, not the City. Public Works does the maintenance and mowing.

Ms. Rock asked about curbs and fencing that is in place now. Mr. Bergeron said there is no grandfather clause in the ordinance. Public Works would make that determination. Mr. Sweet said Public Works would keep track of anything new. They don't mind people putting down wreaths.

Mr. Koloski said he was not comfortable discussing this further without the City Attorney being present.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Pope, for discussion, to table this motion until the next Council meeting on October 26th.

Roll call vote: motion carried 6-2 with Messrs. Pope and Bergeron voting no.

Police Facebook Progress Report

Police Chief Alex Scott said the framework is not complete. The department has not had time to do it. He hopes it will be done before the end of the year.

NEW BUSINESS

Motion to Approve Updated Investment Policy

Mary Walter, Finance Director, said this is an annual update. Some revisions were made according to NH RSAs.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Raymond that the Claremont City Council, pursuant to RSA 47:6 and RSA 48:16, hereby re-adopts the City of Claremont Investment Policy, as amended, and authorizes the City Manager or his designees to take such actions as may be necessary to implement said Investment Policy in accordance with state law and regulation.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

Motion to Re-Approve Identity Theft Prevention Policy

Ms. Walter said this is an annual program.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Raymond that the Claremont City Council, pursuant to the "Fair and Accurate Credit Transactions Act of 2003," the "Red Flag Clarification Act of 2010" and Federal Regulation Title 16 Part 681, hereby approves the City of Claremont Identity Theft Prevention Program and authorizes the City Manager or his designees to take such actions as may be necessary to implement said Identity Theft Prevention Program in accordance with applicable federal and state law and regulation.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

Resolution 2017-12 Economic Revitalization Zone Washington St. – Public Hearing

New Hampshire RSA Chapter 162-N provides state business tax incentives to encourage job growth and expansion of private commercial or industrial base through the establishment of Economic Revitalization Zones (ERZ) in certain areas of the state. In order to establish an ERZ, the local governing body must petition the Commissioner of Resources and Economic Development to designate an ERZ within the municipality and certify that it meets the statutory requirements. This designation will enable new and existing businesses in an ERZ to establish eligibility for certain business tax credits. This is for the Washington Street ERZ.

<u>Map/Lot</u>	<u>Name</u>	<u>Address</u>	<u>Notes</u>
133/1	Lightening Ridge Realty Trust	364 Washington St.	vacant
145/27	Moose Mountain Realty Trust	366 Washington St.	vacant
145/26	Robert Landry Trust	Washington St.	vacant
146/17	Robert Landry Trust	392 Washington St.	vacant
146/18	Ski/Sky	400 Washington St.	large lot
145/23	DSM Realty	367 Washington St.	large tenant vacancy

A motion was made by Mr. Raymond and seconded by Ms. Towle to adopt Resolution 2017-12 Economic Revitalization Zone Washington St.

Mr. Raymond read the resolution into the record.

Nancy Merrill, Planning and Development Director, said this is a state business tax credit program. It does not impact local taxes. It is for contiguous properties. Once designated, businesses can apply to the state for tax credits against their business tax. She said it does no harm and may benefit businesses coming in. She said the properties have to be contiguous properties.

Ms. Merrill said there is no maximum number of ERZs in a community, however the Twistback ERZ will be taken off the list because it no longer qualifies as an underperforming economic area. Currently there are five ERZs in the City.

Mr. Bergeron opened the public hearing. No one spoke. He closed it.

Roll call vote: motion carried 8-0.

Resolution 2017-11 Adopting Hazard Mitigation Plan Update – Public Hearing

The City of Claremont has received assistance from the Upper Valley Lake Sunapee Regional Planning Commission through funding from NH Homeland Security and Emergency Management to prepare a hazard mitigation updated plan. Several planning meetings to develop the hazard mitigation plan update were held in June and July 2016. The hazard mitigation plan update was presented to the City Council for review, discussion and approval on October 12, 2016. The Claremont Hazard Mitigation Plan Update 2016 contains several potential future projects to mitigate hazard damage from various natural events in the City of Claremont.

The City of Claremont City Council resolves:

1. The Plan is hereby adopted as an official plan of the City of Claremont;
2. The respective officials identified in the mitigation strategy of the Plan are hereby directed to pursue implementation of the recommended actions assigned to them;
3. Future revisions and Plan maintenance required by 44 CFR 201.6 and FEMA are hereby adopted as a part of this resolution for a period of five (5) years from the date of this resolution.
4. An annual report on the progress of the implementation elements of the Plan shall be presented to the City Council by the Emergency Management Director.

Fire Chief Rick Bergeron said the City has to update and re-adopt the Hazard Mitigation Plan every five years. It is a hazard risk analysis of community which includes flooding, blizzards, wind storms, etc. It was reviewed by City administration as guided by Upper Valley Lakes Sunapee Regional Planning Commission (UVLSRPC). It was sent to FEMA for review and now it is being presented to the Council for adoption.

A motion was made by Mr. Simonds and seconded by Ms. Towle to adopt Resolution 2017-11 Adopting Hazard Mitigation Plan Update.

Mr. Simonds read the resolution into the record.

Mr. Bergeron opened to public hearing. No one spoke. He closed it.

Roll call vote: motion carried 8-0.

Resolution 2017-13 to Accept and Expend \$10,857.60 New Hampshire Highway Safety Grant for Claremont DWI Patrols – Public Hearing

The City of Claremont, New Hampshire has applied for and been awarded a New Hampshire Highway Safety Grant for DWI Patrols in the amount of \$10,857.60 for the period ending September 30th, 2017. The City would like to accept and expend the grant funds for their intended purpose. This is to raise and appropriate the sum of \$10,857.60 for the Police Department from off-setting grant revenue (to have no impact on the tax rate) for the purpose of DWI patrols by the Claremont Police Department.

Police Chief Alex Scott said this is for DWI patrols from October 2016 through September 2017.

A motion was made by Mr. Raymond and seconded by Mr. Simonds to adopt Resolution 2017-13 to Accept and Expend \$10,857.60 New Hampshire Highway Safety Grant for Claremont DWI Patrols.

Mr. Raymond read the resolution into the record.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Simonds to amend the resolution where it reads “Be it further resolved to raise and appropriate...” change to “Be it further resolved to raise, appropriate and expend.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

Mr. Bergeron opened the public hearing. No one spoke. He closed it.

Roll call vote on the amended resolution: motion carried 8-0.

Resolution 2017-14 to Accept and Expend \$11,066.40 New Hampshire Highway Safety Grant for Claremont STEP Program – Public Hearing

The City of Claremont, New Hampshire has applied for and been awarded a New Hampshire Highway Safety Selective Targeted Enforcement Program (STEP) Grant in the amount of \$11,066.40 for the period ending September 30th, 2017. The City would like to accept and expend the grant funds for their intended purpose. This is to raise and appropriate the sum of \$11,066.40 for the Police Department from off-setting grant revenue (to have no impact on the tax rate) for the purpose of implementing the STEP.

Chief Scott said this grant is a consolidation of the NH Join the Click Seatbelt Program, Safe Commute Traffic Enforcement Program and Strategic Traffic Enforcement Program. He said this will be focused on Washington Street, Main Street and Charlestown Road. It will run from October 2016 to September 2017.

A motion was made by Mr. Simonds and seconded by Ms. Towle to adopt Resolution 2017-14 to Accept and Expend \$11,066.40 New Hampshire Highway Safety Grant for Claremont STEP Program.

Mr. Simonds read the resolution into the record.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Raymond to amend the resolution where it reads “Be it further resolved to raise and appropriate...” change to “Be it further resolved to raise, appropriate and expend.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

Mr. Bergeron opened the public hearing. No one spoke. He closed it.

Roll call vote on the amended resolution: motion carried 8-0.

Ordinance 549 Water & Sewer Rates – First Reading

Victor St. Pierre, Assistant Public Works Director, presented six different options for review.

- Option 1 Increase water rates 7.5% a year to cover operating costs and existing debt (No Capital Projects).
- Option 2 Increase water rates 8.5% a year to cover operating costs, existing debt and required CIP. CIP includes \$500,000 for Lead Service Replacement and \$105,000 for White Water Spillway.
- Option 3 Increase water rates 14% a year to cover operating costs, existing debt and new capital plan. Decrease sewer rates 2.5% a year to cover operating costs, existing debt and new capital plan. This draws down the water cash balance from \$2.5 million in FY 2016 to \$2.1 million in FY 2021. This draws down the sewer cash balance from \$4.5 million in FY 2016 to \$3.1 million in FY 2021. The City does not recommend this one.
- Option 4 Freeze Tier 1 water usage level (0-2,000 CF) at current rate of \$2.40/100 cf. Other water rates increase 17.5%, Sewer rates remain as is and new capital plan is included. City Staff recommends this one. This draws down the water cash balance from \$2.5 million in FY 2016 to \$2.0 million in FY 2021. This draws down the sewer cash balance from \$4.5 million in FY 2016 to \$3.8 million in FY 2021. The only debt funded sewer project is the mains on Summer Street for \$700,000 in FY 2021.
- Option 5 Increase water rates 14.0% a year to cover operating costs, existing debt and new CIP plan.
- Option 6 Increase water rates 17.5% a year to cover operating costs, existing debt, original CIP plan. This was the original proposal.

Mr. St. Pierre said NH is in a state of drought. Also, he said there has been a 40% decrease in the amount of water being used in the City, but the costs are still going up. With Option 4, 2017 and 2018, the rates will still be below comparable communities. Starting in 2019, the rates will be above some other communities. This will come to the Council every year for re-approval.

Mr. Pope believes Option 4 will help retirees and those on limited income and will encourage conservation.

Mr. Bergeron said the Mayor had given him her recommendation and that is to fund the operation and debt and no more for this year. Scott Sweet, Public Works Director, said if you do that, he would suggest going with Option 2 because the City is required to do the White Water Spillway and the lead removal.

Mr. Santagate asked with the cut in rate increases, what projects will be cut out. Mr. St. Pierre said the City did not get the Tiger Grant which means the Charlestown Road sewer project has been moved into the 6th year of the Capital Improvements Plan. Some of the forestry money will be used for the spillways. He would like to continue with meter replacement program to save money in the long run.

Ms. Walter said the semi-annual bill increase for Option 2 is \$44 and Option 4 is \$49, so for \$5 more in six months, you can continue with the meter read program and do other things in the CIP.

Mr. Santagate said it doesn't generate much new money. Ms. Walter said Option 4 draws down cash balance and it doesn't generate a lot of money.

Mr. Santagate said to keep the increases low, will affect the lead service replacement program. He said Council needs to keep in mind that they may have to pass up some of these programs that are essential.

There was a discussion about replacing the 100 or so lead service lines and how it will be funded (i.e. SRF loan, which may offer 20% forgiveness).

Mr. St. Pierre said they hope to use the SRF funding from the state, but reduce the operating budget by keeping that project in-house.

Mr. Santagate said that this doesn't solve the financial condition in that department. These rates don't do that. The City originally came to the Council with a higher rate, but Council didn't want it. Options 2 and 4 don't solve that issue. With lead, you don't know what is underground, so we won't know how much it will cost.

Mr. St. Pierre said if all the lead is out by next July, he'll ask for the same budget as this year.

Mr. Temple asked about doing water on Ascutney and Lafayette Streets that are on the 2018-19 Sewer plan. Mr. Sweet said that is a sewer separation on Ascutney.

Mr. Temple pointed out the anticipated reserves (rainy day check book fund) will be drawn down significantly with these options.

Mr. Damren said each option draws down reserve funds to some degree. He likes option 4. Customarily you wouldn't borrow money for operations.

Ms. Walter said this year's budget has \$1.5 million coming out of reserves. This is no different than when Police get a grant and then charge that person's time to that grant. They will save money by using their own people then they will charge their time to the SRF to do this capital project. What they don't spend in the operating budget will drop into fund balance, back into retained earnings or they will do another project such as the meter read program.

Mr. Damren said because the capital reserve will not be drawn down as much as expected, that may affect the water rates next year.

Mr. Temple said he can't imagine replacing 150 services, reducing the operating budget and deferring it out for the next 20 years.

Mr. Santagate said what are coming are issues that you either settle now, or you settle later. It's easier to go with a lower rate, but he wanted the Council to understand the City will not be able to do some necessary projects.

Mr. Temple said this can be done if you fully fund the rates and don't borrow the money. Ms. Walter said the average bill would increase \$109 every 6 months over 5 years.

Ms. Towle talked about the Charlestown Road issue and economic development. She said you can't keep improving the Charlestown Road area without fixing the sewer in that area.

Mr. Bergeron wants more information about the loan.

Mr. Temple asked if the lead removal is mandated across the state. He suggested contacting Representative John Cloutier. Mr. Temple said he is concerned about drawing down reserves.

Mr. St. Pierre said that Ordinance 549 is option 4.

Ms. Walter said the last plan was for 6 years because it followed the CIP plan. This plan is for 5 years. Council can review it every year. If Council does nothing, the fees go into effect.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Raymond to adopt Ordinance 549 Water & Sewer Rates on first reading.

Mr. Damren read the Explanation of Proposed Action into the record.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

Resolution 2017-15 Moose Plate Grant for Cemetery Records – Public Hearing

The City has applied for and been notified that it has been awarded a Moose License Plate Conservation Grant from the New Hampshire Department of Cultural Resources in the amount of \$9,245.00 to fund additional preservation of the City's Cemetery Record Books (the "Project"). The City would like to accept and expend said grant funds. The money will be taken from unanticipated revenue (to have no impact on the tax rate) for the purpose of funding the Project.

Mr. Sweet said this is for the last 6 cemetery books. It will help preserve the books.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Towle to adopt Resolution 2017-15 Moose Plate Grant for Cemetery Records.

Mr. Damren read the resolution into the record.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Towle to amend the motion on the next to the last paragraph to change it to be “raise, appropriate, and expend.”

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

Roll call vote on the resolution as amended: motion carried 8-0.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Ms. Towle said the Zoning Board of Adjustment (ZBA) has tentatively set October 19th for a joint Planning Board and ZBA site review for 154 North Street.

Mr. Pope said the Historic District Commission has seen an uptick in applications for buildings to be renovated (i.e. Real Steel, chocolate factory, former Old Hometown Deli) in the Historic district. Also, he mentioned the school strategic plan is being developed. A forum is tentatively scheduled for November 3rd, 6-7:30 p.m. to gather public input.

Mr. Bergeron read a letter received from Mr. Gould, MRI today: 37 candidates; 1 candidate has withdrawn because of acceptance of another job; submittals will be sent to the Screening Committee by the week of October 21st.

Mr. Bergeron read a letter from City Manager Search Screening Committee Co-Chair Bethany Yurek addressed to the Mayor. Ms. Yurek asked for assurance that the next City Manager has not already been chosen and that her previous comments were intended to underscore the need for an open, inclusive and transparent process to finding the most qualified candidate to be the next City Manager. She gave a description of the 2001 search for a City Manager where a candidate who was hired stayed for only 18 days before resigning. Again, she asked for assurances this process would be open, meaningful and inclusive of taxpayers in the community.

There was a brief discussion about the letter from Ms. Yurek.

Mr. Bergeron said Municipal Resources Inc. is on track to do the job. He said regarding the letter from Ms. Yurek, that without proof, it's only hearsay.

Councilors said they don't know the names of the candidates.

Mr. Bergeron said that members of the public can call MRI; the meetings are open to the public; and there is plenty of time for people to get involved.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilors agreed to do the second reading on the water rates at the first meeting in November.

Mr. Koloski expressed his frustration with using the laptop computer for reading the information from the Council packet. He requested to have a paper copy of the packet and that the Police Department does not have to deliver it to him. He'll pick it up.

Mr. Pope will work with Ms. Towle to help her become more proficient with her laptop.

Mr. Temple asked about the merge of Moody Park and City property and having it resurveyed and recorded as one property. If the City needs to take the money out of the forestry fund to do it, he would be in favor of it. Mr. Bergeron asked Mr. Santagate to put it on the November 9th agenda.

Mr. Pope reminded Council of some big issues that need to be resolved such as the City Manager search and still owing Ridge Avenue residents an answer. Mr. Bergeron said Ridge Avenue will have to wait until the Conservation Commission does its thing which shouldn't take long.

Ms. Towle is concerned that the Fire Department Director has issues with non-compliant property owners and needs help. She said the \$100 fine doesn't seem to be a sufficient deterrent, so the City needs to check what other communities are doing.

Mr. Bergeron said the Planning Board is finding that when they do the inspections is when they find that the property owner has added a unit without approval.

Mr. Koloski asked if the multi-family housing inspection issue was on the next agenda. Mr. Santagate said yes.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None

ADJOURNMENT

At 9:38 p.m., a motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Temple to adjourn.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

Respectfully Submitted,

Dorée M. Russell
Clerk to the Council